

TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 4 OF SIX

The Department of Things That Fit Into Other Things

Puzzles, mechanisms, creative toys and retro desktop diversions

Forty real games. One wildly unnecessary department.

A comic companion, written by ChatGPT under Nolan's creative direction.

Reader edition 1.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

Before the stamp hits the page

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; Aiden's ministry and rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. Promising, conditional and detour are editorial labels, not measurements of anyone's ability. Read the catch on the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 4. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department's forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index at the back always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P121	P122	P123	P124	P125	P126	P127	P128
2. Ready for conversation	P129	P130	P131	P132	P133	P134	P135	P136
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P137	P138	P139	P140	P141	P142	P143	P144
4. Here for the atmosphere	P145	P146	P147	P148	P149	P150	P151	P152
5. Open to a wildcard	P153	P154	P155	P156	P157	P158	P159	P160

Local position = $8 \times (\text{row} - 1) + \text{emblem}$. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = $40 \times (\text{department} - 1) + \text{local position}$.

The Cabinet Refuses the Binder

I bought the cabinet because its label said STORAGE SOLUTION. I considered this a binding professional promise. The cabinet arrived flat, which was the first sign that it expected me to participate in the solution. Tank carried the pieces inside and laid them next to the table. Shawna found the instructions. I found the decorative nameplate I had ordered separately and placed it where the finished cabinet would eventually have a chest.

'You bought a nameplate before checking the measurements,' Mercedes said. 'A institution needs an identity,' I replied. 'It also needs to fit through the doorway.' Rosa brought tea, examined the wall and quietly moved a vase beyond the area in which my confidence was most likely to cause damage. Tank held two boards together. The pieces looked deceptively simple. There were only a few shapes, a small bag of fittings, and an unlimited number of ways for me to explain that the problem was somebody else's.

The binder was supposed to go in the top compartment. It did not. I turned it sideways. The cabinet declined. I removed a page, which reduced the thickness by an amount Tank described as emotionally significant. Shawna asked why I had started assembling a storage system around an object without measuring the object. I told her the binder represented a living vision. She handed me a tape measure. 'Then let's see how long it lives.'

This was the moment the Department of Things That Fit Into Other Things discovered its subject. A puzzle can use a few familiar actions and still ask a wonderfully difficult question. A quiet board can offer deep reasoning. A richly rendered cabinet can conceal a control that needs a held drag. An attractive cartoon can contain a severe logic problem, while a serious-looking mechanism can become perfectly readable once somebody shows you what moves. Appearance and physical demand had been filing reports in the same folder. Shawna separated them.

I proposed three labels: BRILLIANT, EXTREMELY BRILLIANT, and AWAITING MY ARRIVAL. Mercedes crossed them out. Rosa wrote two actual questions on an index card: Do I want to know what happens? Does doing it feel good? Tank added a third: Is Aiden standing on the instructions? I stepped aside. Under my shoe, a diagram showed the shelf fitted the other way around. The cabinet had not been refusing the binder. It had been refusing my interpretation of a rectangle.

We agreed that the book could contain difficult reasoning without pretending every difficulty was the same. A game could wait patiently while a person considered a complicated relationship. Another could demand a quick movement despite its thoughtful story. A puzzle about changing rules might be exciting; a menu full of tiny icons might merely be tedious. The job was to say which activity was actually on offer, identify the catch, and leave the decision with the person who would play.

I tried to turn this agreement into a certification scheme. Shawna said a useful description would do. I tried to add a compulsory introductory lecture. Rosa said the tea would get cold. Mercedes selected a page directly, bypassing my entire route system, and the floor remained under us. Tank fitted the shelf correctly. The binder still protruded a little, but the cabinet now served a purpose. I attached the nameplate on the inside, where its authority would interfere with fewer people.

P121 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Baba Is You

The Law Has Been Pushed One Square to the Left

Edition considered: PC release

I wrote AIDEN IS IN CHARGE on a card and placed it at the head of the table. Shawna removed IN CHARGE and replaced it with FURNITURE. Tank immediately asked whether I was available to support the snack bowl. I objected that words could not simply alter the governing order. Then we opened Baba Is You, which made that argument difficult to sustain.

The little blocks did more than describe the world. Moving them changed what the world allowed. Rosa experimented with a sentence instead of defending the first arrangement. Mercedes asked whether my title was useful if it prevented us from reaching the interesting part. I considered this a suspiciously specific philosophical attack. Then a rule changed, the puzzle opened in a new direction and I forgot to be offended. The card at the head of the table now read AIDEN IS THINKING. For once, nobody challenged its accuracy.

The actual attraction

Baba Is You turns the rules of a puzzle into objects you can move. A short arrangement of words can transform what a wall, flag or character does. The appeal is the surprise of realizing that the rule you assumed was fixed is actually the thing to manipulate.

The catch worth knowing

The small number of movement actions should not be confused with easy reasoning. The developer describes a large collection of increasingly inventive rule interactions. Reading the words, predicting consequences and revising a plan can become demanding. Check the exact movement, undo and restart controls rather than assuming they are comfortable because the board is compact.

An opening invitation

Try an introductory level and deliberately move one rule word. Observe what changes before attempting a long solution or consulting an entire set of hints.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The legislature authorizes rewriting the wall, but nobody is required to solve grammar's revenge before enjoying a biscuit.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/736260/>

P122 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: waits / native co-op: no

Patrick's Parabox

The Storage Box Contains the Storage Department

Edition considered: PC release

I bought a box to hold the smaller boxes. This was a sensible beginning. Then I discovered a box that contained itself, and my inventory system suffered a spiritual injury. Tank asked whether we could put the binder inside it and recover the table. I said the implications required study. He said the table required space.

Shawna pushed one box and demonstrated that the strange rule could be understood through an ordinary action. Rosa followed the relationship between the outside and the inside. Mercedes suggested that I stop trying to name every layer before moving anything. I did, and the puzzle became less like an insult from mathematics and more like a toy with an unfamiliar but learnable grammar. The storage department remained confused about its office address. That was acceptable. We had reached a point where confusion was producing curiosity instead of another requisition form.

The actual attraction

Patrick's Parabox explores boxes that contain other boxes, including recursive arrangements. The repeated act of pushing gains new meaning as the space folds into itself. Its interest is in discovering how a small set of relationships can support surprisingly rich puzzles.

The catch worth knowing

The current Steam listing declares play without timed input and keyboard-only support. Spatial nesting can still require holding several relationships in mind even when the controls are limited. Verify key repeat, undo and any zoom behavior in the actual version. There is little conventional character story to carry the experience if the recursive logic itself does not appeal.

An opening invitation

Play the earliest introduction to entering and leaving a box. Explain one relationship aloud if useful, then try a move that tests that explanation.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The Department of Storage may now fit inside its own cabinet, but its annual report must remain shorter than the cabinet.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1260520/>

P123 / **CONDITIONAL** / directional input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Stephen's Sausage Roll

The Catering Subcommittee Has Become a Logic Problem

Edition considered: PC release

I assumed the sausage would be the easiest item on the agenda. This was before the fork, the narrow space and my rapidly declining confidence became involved. Tank watched me consider the arrangement. 'You could admit you need to think.' 'I am allowing the ingredients to reveal their strategy.'

Rosa asked whether the sausage had consented to becoming a strategic actor. Shawna suggested making one move and seeing what it taught us. Mercedes declined my proposal to call the situation a catering emergency. There was no emergency. There was a small, exact problem that did not care how confidently I described it. I found that annoying and then, unexpectedly, satisfying. A better idea arrived only after I stopped trying to make my first idea look correct. Tank said this was the most educational lunch we had never eaten. I asked him not to put that on the menu.

The actual attraction

Stephen's Sausage Roll is a compact three-dimensional puzzle game built around unusually exact spatial problems. Its appeal is the satisfaction of understanding a small arrangement deeply enough to make it work. It belongs on the reasoning shelf for someone who enjoys a stubborn little mechanism more than an expansive story.

The catch worth knowing

The inspected primary storefront supplies very little detailed control information, so this card does not certify timing, holds or the full interaction set. The title's cheerful food premise should not imply easy puzzles. Treat both input comfort and the amount of planning as questions for an early trial, with no expectation of quick completion.

An opening invitation

Inspect the first small puzzle and test a single movement. If the rules interest you, try one hypothesis; if they merely irritate, leave the plate unfinished.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The sausage is excused from being dinner and appointed a temporary consultant on the limits of executive confidence.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-game Steam description is very brief ('A simple 3d puzzle game'); source supports identity and basic genre, not detailed control or difficulty certification. Scene is original fiction. Specific input and full-game timing remain to be checked.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/353540/>

P124 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Snakebird

The Bird Has Exceeded the Approved Length for Birds

Edition considered: PC original game

I requested a bird of standard dimensions. The bird ate fruit and became longer, which I considered an unauthorized amendment to the seating plan. Tank suggested reserving two chairs. Then it grew again. My hospitality model was losing ground to produce.

Shawna asked what the extra length made possible. I had been so busy declaring it inconvenient that I had not considered usefulness. Rosa watched the shape cross a gap in a way a shorter creature could not. Mercedes said a constraint sometimes becomes a tool if you stop insisting it should be something else. I wrote that down, then discovered I had used the entire width of the page. Tank offered a longer sheet and waited for the irony to reach me. Eventually it did. We returned to the puzzle with a better question: not how to make the bird ordinary, but how to use the bird we had.

The actual attraction

Snakebird makes the length and shape of its fruit-eating creatures central to spatial puzzles. What looks like a small comic animal becomes a tool for crossing, supporting and arranging a route. The attraction is the way a simple change in body length changes the whole problem.

The catch worth knowing

The developer explicitly calls the game deceptively challenging. A friendly drawing and a small board should not be sold as easy reasoning. Check directional input, switching between creatures and recovery from mistakes. The card does not establish universal no-timing behavior from genre alone; its strongest case is for a player who enjoys concentrated spatial experimentation.

An opening invitation

Try the earliest fruit-and-exit arrangement. Notice what the new length permits before attempting to plan several moves ahead.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The bird may exceed the furniture specification; the reader may decline the puzzle without submitting a shorter bird.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/357300/>

P125 / PROMISING / directional input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Snakebird Primer

The Orientation Bird Has Brought a Smaller Problem

Edition considered: PC separate prequel game

After our first encounter with an extremely long bird, I commissioned an orientation program. It contained a twenty-page introduction to the concept of fruit. Shawna removed nineteen pages. Tank ate the visual aid on the remaining one. We were forced to begin with the actual game.

The new island introduced its ideas with less apparent hostility to our afternoon. Rosa appreciated having room to learn a pattern before the pattern acquired relatives. Mercedes said a gentler introduction did not make the activity lesser; it made the invitation clearer. I agreed, then tried to call myself the architect of this educational philosophy. Shawna pointed to the developer's name. I withdrew the claim and concentrated on the creature in front of us. One small success led naturally to another question. This was a much better orientation than my speech about the historic significance of the banana.

The actual attraction

Snakebird Primer is a separate set of puzzles designed as a more approachable introduction to Snakebird's spatial ideas. The developer explicitly contrasts its easier island with the original game's serious challenges. It can be a useful place to discover whether moving and shaping these creatures is pleasurable before choosing the harder title.

The catch worth knowing

Easier is a comparison, not a personal guarantee. Directional movement, visual planning and keeping track of a changing shape still matter. Check undo, restart and control repetition in the exact release. The appeal remains puzzle logic rather than rich character dialogue, and a player need not graduate to the original game to justify enjoying this one.

An opening invitation

Complete or explore one introductory arrangement, focusing on how fruit changes the creature. Let curiosity about the next idea decide whether to continue.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The orientation certificate is optional, the banana is gone and nobody has been enrolled in mandatory advanced bird studies.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1014140/>

P126 / PROMISING / directional input / pace: waits / native co-op: no

A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build

The Snowman Has Asked Me to Stop Calling Him a Deliverable

Edition considered: PC release

I set a target of three snowmen before lunch. Rosa asked why. 'A department requires outputs.' She looked at the small monster on the screen, then at me. 'Maybe the monster wants to make one nice snowman.' Tank supported this position, partly because lunch was already approaching without any help from my target.

Shawna studied how the snowballs occupied the space. Mercedes wondered what would happen if I stopped measuring the afternoon by completed figures. I tried making one deliberate move. The little arrangement became interesting in itself: size, position and the order in which things could happen. My production chart began to look ridiculous beside it. I turned the chart over and drew a face on the back. Tank said it was my most useful contribution so far. I gave the face a senior title anyway, because reform is a gradual process.

The actual attraction

A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build makes a small, affectionate premise into a spatial puzzle: a monster creating snowmen. The compact scenes invite attention to a few objects and how their positions relate. It can offer a satisfying repeated activity without needing a sprawling world or a dense inventory story.

The catch worth knowing

The current developer listing declares play without timed input and keyboard-only support. Check movement, undo and snowball manipulation on the chosen device; those declarations do not establish that every action avoids holding. The puzzles still require planning and trial, so the gentle presentation should not become a promise of effortless solutions. Narrative is limited to the charm of the activity.

An opening invitation

Try making one snowman and notice where your first plan changes. Learn the recovery control before treating a mistaken move as a reason to restart everything.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The snowman is recognized as a pleasant use of an afternoon and exempted from quarterly productivity reporting.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/316610/>

P127 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: waits / native co-op: no

Cosmic Express

The Railway Can Carry One Passenger and All of My Mistakes

Edition considered: PC release

I promised the aliens a world-class transit system. Then I discovered the passenger car could carry only one of them at a time. Tank asked whether my promise had included capacity planning. I said the service emphasized intimacy. Shawna began drawing a route that actually reached the houses.

Every turn in the track mattered. Rosa considered the passengers as destinations rather than decorative obstacles. Mercedes asked me to stop calling a loop around nowhere a scenic service. I erased the loop. Another route almost worked, which was somehow more interesting than my first confident answer. We watched the small consequences accumulate until the problem became clear. The station did not need a grand announcement. It needed a track that delivered somebody home. I canceled the ribbon ceremony and spent the saved time looking at the final corner. This improved transport more than any of my slogans.

The actual attraction

Cosmic Express asks you to lay railway routes through small space stations and deliver their residents. The one-passenger constraint makes the order of visits important. Its appeal is the clean relationship between a visible route and the consequences that follow from it.

The catch worth knowing

The developer describes the puzzles as difficult and separately declares play without timed input, with keyboard-only and mouse-only options. Drawing tracks may still involve sustained pointer actions, so test the intended input method. Cute passengers do not reduce the planning burden: a compact station can hold a demanding puzzle. The declared input options do not certify hold-free interaction.

An opening invitation

Draw a route in an early station and watch one passenger's trip. Test editing or resetting the route before trying to optimize a complicated arrangement.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The railway is authorized to be small, provided it goes somewhere more useful than the minister's opening speech.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option plus Mouse Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/583270/>

P128 / PROMISING / directional input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

A Monster's Expedition

The Museum Has Mistaken My Stapler for a Ceremonial Animal

Edition considered: PC release

I have always believed ordinary office equipment deserves more respect. Then the monsters began interpreting human objects, and I discovered that respect can take a very strange shape when nobody knows what anything was for. Tank said the red stapler did look like a small creature with a bad attitude.

Rosa read the exhibit with delight. Shawna examined the little island and the tree that might become a path. Mercedes asked whether our own explanations of unfamiliar things were always more reliable. I began to answer confidently, then remembered several recent incidents involving birds, boxes and an allegedly criminal shrub. We tried moving the tree instead. It produced a concrete result, unlike my lecture. The next island held another object and another chance to be amused by certainty. I quietly changed my proposed museum plaque from 'Authoritative History' to 'A Person Had a Guess.'

The actual attraction

A Monster's Expedition combines tree-pushing spatial puzzles with comic museum observations about humanity. Small islands form a larger exploratory structure, so solving a route can lead to both a new place and a new joke. It offers a particular mix of thoughtful manipulation and dry amusement.

The catch worth knowing

The developer describes simple mechanics with substantial depth. That depth can mean difficult planning even when the action vocabulary is small. Check movement, undo, reset and the readability of the islands and exhibits. Its open structure should not be treated as proof that every puzzle is optional or that every route remains easy.

An opening invitation

Solve or experiment with one early crossing, then read the nearby exhibit. Judge whether the combination of puzzle and joke makes you want another island.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The stapler may remain a ceremonial animal until someone produces evidence that its bite served a different social purpose.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1052990/>

P129 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Bonfire Peaks

The Archive Has Been Asked to Consider Letting Something Go

Edition considered: PC release

I objected to the premise on professional grounds. An archive exists to keep things. The game appeared interested in leaving them behind. Tank looked at the three binders beneath my chair and said the game might have a point. I said those binders contained important historical context. Shawna opened one. It contained old versions of the same seating chart.

Rosa suggested that choosing what to release could be as meaningful as collecting. Mercedes added that a difficult object did not become valuable merely because I had carried it a long way. This was a troubling conversation to have beside a puzzle about movement and cargo. I tried arranging the next few steps without defending the entire archive. The small physical problem gave the larger idea room to breathe. I did not immediately throw away a binder. I did, however, admit that one of them could become a doorstep without betraying civilization.

The actual attraction

Bonfire Peaks presents a spatial puzzle journey organized around closure and moving onward. Its compact, sculptural environments make objects and their placement visually central. It may appeal when the satisfaction of an exact arrangement is strengthened by a quiet theme about what people carry.

The catch worth knowing

The primary description promises rewarding challenges and evolving mechanics, not low difficulty. Manipulating objects in three-dimensional puzzle spaces may require careful orientation and planning. Check the actual movement and object controls before assuming the fixed-looking presentation eliminates physical demands. The emotional theme is suggestive rather than a richly voiced character drama.

An opening invitation

Inspect an early puzzle, learn one object interaction and test how to recover from a mistake. Continue only if the precise arrangement feels absorbing rather than burdensome.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

One obsolete binder may be released from service; the minister is permitted to survive the loss without commissioning a memorial.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1147890/>

P130 / PROMISING / directional input / pace: waits / native co-op: no

Can of Wormholes

The Hint Department Has Built a Smaller Puzzle Instead of a Lecture

Edition considered: PC release

I opened the can expecting a manageable administrative issue. Worms were involved, then space behaved strangely, and before long I was considering whether a can could file a complaint against its own contents. Tank said the title had provided adequate warning. I argued that warning and preparation were different budgets.

Shawna noticed the hint system. Instead of simply handing over an answer, it offered a smaller playable idea. Rosa liked that: a nudge that still left discovery in the player's hands. Mercedes asked whether my own explanations could become shorter and more useful in the same way. I said yes, then took four sentences to prove that I had not yet achieved it. We tried the small hint puzzle. Something clicked. The larger problem changed from a wall into a question we could work with. I appointed the tiny puzzle head of training and accepted a probationary role.

The actual attraction

Can of Wormholes develops many interactions from a small collection of puzzle objects. Its distinctive strength for this catalogue is a documented playable hint system: a smaller related stage can suggest the insight needed for the larger one. Experimentation and discovery are the main rewards.

The catch worth knowing

The developer explicitly states that no time-critical inputs or simultaneous key presses are required, and documents unlimited undo and restart. Those are unusually useful concrete claims. Keyboard or gamepad play is supported, with a Mac gamepad limitation noted by the developer. Spatial reasoning and learning new interactions can still be demanding; hold behavior should be checked separately.

An opening invitation

Try an introductory stage, use undo once and inspect a playable hint if curiosity stalls. Learn how the support works before a difficult puzzle makes it feel urgent.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The training department is approved because it offers a useful smaller idea instead of requiring attendance at my worm-related keynote.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Developer Steam description explicitly says no time-critical input or simultaneous key presses, unlimited undo/restart and playable hints; gamepad on Mac is not currently supported in that description. This supports the stated narrow timing claims, not universal hold-free operation.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1295320/>

The Undo Budget

I established an Undo Budget after noticing how often a puzzle could become interesting precisely when an earlier idea turned out to be wrong. The proposal included a request form, a committee and a modest administrative charge payable in public acknowledgment of my foresight. Tank asked whether we could undo the proposal. I said that would require the form. Shawna tore the form in half. Apparently the department had discovered a direct-action interface.

Rosa put two of the cabinet's spare fittings on the table. She moved one, considered the result, then put it back. 'That's all,' she said. 'Sometimes trying an idea is how you find out what the problem is.' Mercedes added that a mistake should not automatically become a performance review. I had been preparing a report on the fitting's lack of ambition, so this intervention saved everyone several pages.

Undo and restart still needed to be checked in the actual game. We could not award them by wishing, and we could not assume that a feature in one installment existed in another. But when a useful reversal was present, it changed the feeling of experimentation. A move could be a question. An unsuccessful arrangement could leave behind a better understanding. Nobody had to preserve the first idea simply because I had stamped it.

I attempted to undo my purchase of the oversized binder. Tank said that feature belonged to the shop's returns policy, not the puzzle. We found a practical alternative: divide the contents into smaller volumes and keep the route card visible. It was not a spectacular solution, which made it unusually easy to explain. I claimed the improvement as a triumph of iterative leadership. Mercedes asked whether she could undo that sentence. We let her.

P131 / DETOUR / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: no

Braid, Anniversary Edition

I Would Like to Rewind the Part Where I Announced Expertise

Edition considered: PC Anniversary Edition

The ability to reverse time struck me as the most promising administrative reform in history. I could retract an entire speech without issuing a correction. Tank asked whether I would use it before or after we had heard the speech. I said the implementation details were still being negotiated.

Then the game made time part of a puzzle rather than a service for preserving my reputation. Shawna watched how the rules changed between places. Rosa noticed the memories and regrets woven into the journey. Mercedes pointed out that undoing an action and understanding it were not the same thing. I had been hoping they were. We tried a movement again, this time with a different idea. It was satisfying, but it still required the movement. The rewind did not transform my hands into a committee. I recorded that distinction before my enthusiasm could accidentally turn it into a promise.

The actual attraction

Braid, Anniversary Edition combines platform movement with puzzles built around unusual behavior of time. Its story and images concern memory, desire and regret. The new edition also includes extensive creator commentary, offering another route into the design for someone interested in how a game thinks.

The catch worth knowing

Rewinding does not remove jumping, hazards or required movement timing. The developer explicitly describes platforming and changing time mechanics. This is a conditional action-puzzle detour, not a standard no-rush fit. Check movement, jump combinations and rewind holds separately; a forgiving recovery system can reduce failure cost without reducing the action itself.

An opening invitation

Try one introductory movement puzzle and the rewind control. If the physical action is unwelcome, consider the design commentary as an interest to investigate rather than forcing play.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The minister may revise a mistaken move, but the laws of time decline to erase every embarrassing claim of competence.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/499180/>

P132 / **CONDITIONAL** / pointer input / pace: mixed / native co-op: unknown

World of Goo

The Bridge Is Held Together by Optimism and a Concerning Amount of Goo

Edition considered: PC original game

I approved the bridge design because it looked ambitious. Tank asked whether ambition could bear weight. I said history was full of structures people had doubted. Shawna suggested this was not a substitute for examining the lower connection. The lower connection chose that moment to prove her point.

The little living pieces made construction feel less like drawing a line and more like persuading a crowd to hold hands in a dangerous shape. Rosa wanted them to arrive somewhere useful. Mercedes wanted me to stop naming unfinished bridges after myself. I tried a shorter structure. It held a little longer. Another adjustment changed the balance. Soon we were watching cause and effect rather than defending a glorious silhouette. The company in the game appeared to have its own questionable priorities. I felt personally attacked by several of them and therefore suspected the satire was functioning correctly.

The actual attraction

World of Goo turns drag-and-drop construction into a physics puzzle with a comic corporate world around it. Structures bend, balance and fail in visible ways, so a small design change can be satisfying to test. Its personality comes from the creatures, signs and increasingly strange purposes of the construction work.

The catch worth knowing

The primary description explicitly says drag and drop. Holding and positioning the pointer may therefore be a central barrier. Physics unfolds while structures are running, and hazards vary by level, so do not assume an unlimited-waiting solution from the word puzzle. Check the ordinary building loop before becoming invested in the larger campaign.

An opening invitation

Build the smallest useful connection in an early level and watch it behave. Test selecting, dragging and releasing one piece before attempting an elaborate tower.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The bridge may carry traffic after it carries itself; the commemorative nameplate can wait indefinitely.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/22000/>

P133 / **CONDITIONAL** / pointer input / pace: mixed / native co-op: unknown

World of Goo 2

The Company Has Rebranded the Leak as a Sustainability Initiative

Edition considered: PC sequel

The company said everything was greener now. I respected the confidence of a rebrand that arrived before the mess had been cleaned up. Tank pointed to the liquid moving across the scene. 'Is that meant to be there?' I said the press release described it as dynamic. Shawna asked what we needed to do about it.

Rosa was less interested in the logo than in where the little creatures ended up. Mercedes had questions about the company's motives, which the company's imaginary spokesperson answered by changing the subject to the logo again. I recognized a professional at work. Meanwhile, the puzzle demanded a real arrangement of materials and flow. We tried something, watched the result and changed it. No amount of positive messaging altered the liquid's behavior. It was refreshing to encounter a system that could not be talked into pretending my first design had succeeded.

The actual attraction

World of Goo 2 expands the construction idea with flowing liquid, new material behaviors and another satirical corporate story. The attraction is watching a designed structure interact with a physical process, then discovering a better arrangement. It is a distinct sequel with new puzzles rather than an alternative edition of the first game.

The catch worth knowing

The developer describes a dangerous world and varied material mechanics. Pointer precision, holding or dragging, moving liquid and level-specific hazards need assessment. Do not assume that familiarity with one type of goo makes the complete game mechanically simple. This is most plausible when hands-on construction is itself enjoyable, not merely a route to the jokes.

An opening invitation

Try one early construction problem and observe how one material behaves. Check whether editing the structure feels comfortable before attempting to manage several interactions at once.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The sustainability report may use green ink, but the bridge still has to work in the color gravity prefers.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/3385670/>

P134 / DETOUR / mixed input / pace: real time / native co-op: no

HUMANITY

The Crowd Has Voted to Follow the Dog

Edition considered: PC non-VR mode proposed for assessment

I assembled the people and prepared a motivational address. They followed a small dog instead. Tank said the dog's instructions were clearer. I asked whether the dog had ever managed a budget. Shawna noted that it had already moved the crowd farther than my entire opening ceremony.

There was something wonderful about seeing a simple direction produce a large pattern. Rosa watched the people as a flow rather than a set of names on my attendance sheet. Mercedes asked whether I wanted to solve the route or regain the microphone. I chose the route, publicly and with enough emphasis to make the microphone question obvious. The arrangement changed, the crowd turned and a little part of the problem made sense. Then the description mentioned action sections and bosses. Shawna underlined them before I could file the dog under Universally Gentle. Even an excellent supervisor can have demanding working conditions.

The actual attraction

HUMANITY turns crowd direction into a striking puzzle-action spectacle. A dog places commands that shape the movement of many people, making routes and group behavior visible at a large scale. Its visual ideas may appeal to someone who enjoys watching a small instruction transform a complex scene.

The catch worth knowing

The developer explicitly includes action-focused stages, platform-like elements and boss battles. This prevents an unqualified no-rush recommendation. Navigation, command placement and the behavior of moving crowds need checking, and the ordinary-screen version should be assessed separately from VR. A clever planning premise does not remove required reactions elsewhere.

An opening invitation

Inspect an introductory routing stage and test one command. Treat later action sections as a real selection barrier, not a detail to discover after making a commitment.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The dog is promoted on demonstrated performance; the minister is reassigned to checking whether the job description includes boss fights.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1581480/>

P135 / DETOUR / directional input / pace: mixed / native co-op: no

COCOON

The World Has Been Put in a Ball and Assigned to Lost Property

Edition considered: PC release

I found the idea of carrying a whole world extremely efficient. It could reduce the ministry's travel costs to one shelf and a strong bag. Tank asked what happened if we put down the wrong world. I said a labeling policy would prevent that. Shawna watched the game and suggested understanding the relationships before printing labels.

The strange little environments connected in ways that changed what an object could mean. Rosa followed the visual logic without demanding a lecture from every doorway. Mercedes said the mystery benefited from being experienced, not explained into exhaustion by me. I accepted this with the grace of a man temporarily deprived of a podium. Then we read about the guardians. They were not merely decorative custodians of my imaginary lost-property office. The game expected battles. I moved the card to the conditional shelf and admitted that a beautiful system could still ask for actions somebody did not want.

The actual attraction

COCOON builds an alien puzzle adventure around worlds contained within portable orbs. Carrying a world into another world changes what can be done, creating a strong visual form of discovery. The appeal is the elegant connection between an object, a place and a new possibility.

The catch worth knowing

The official description explicitly includes guardian battles with new mechanics. A small-looking action vocabulary therefore does not prove a no-reaction experience. Check movement, aiming or triggering abilities, required timing and the effect of failure. This is a narrow puzzle-adventure detour for someone interested in those interactions, not a default quiet-game recommendation.

An opening invitation

Try the first world-and-orb interaction to see whether its logic feels satisfying. Preview a representative guardian encounter before assuming that the opening describes the full game.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Lost Property will accept an entire world, but it must disclose any guardian currently living inside the claim ticket.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1497440/>

P136 / PROMISING / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Gorogoa

The Picture Has Opened a Door Into the Other Picture

Edition considered: PC release

I arranged four images and announced an exhibition. Mercedes moved one panel, and the exhibition became a mechanism. I said that had been my intention. Tank asked why I had just called the empty space between them 'the artist's silence.' I explained that silence is flexible under pressure.

The images invited a different kind of attention. A shape could be a clue; a frame could become an opening; something small might connect to something far larger. Rosa noticed a relationship I had missed while composing the wall text. Shawna tried the movement and watched what it changed. I found myself looking rather than naming. It was pleasant, and mildly threatening to the catalogue's longest sentences. By the time a new connection appeared, I no longer wanted to preserve my first arrangement. I wanted to see what the next one could reveal. The wall text remained mercifully short.

The actual attraction

Gorogoa tells its story through illustrated panels that the player arranges and combines. Its puzzles depend on visual relationships, scale and the possibility that one image can become part of another. The result can feel like discovering how a picture thinks rather than manipulating a conventional inventory.

The catch worth knowing

Panel movement and visual precision are the main checks. The store supports arranging and combining images, but not a complete hold-free control claim. Inspect whether dragging, zooming or small targets are comfortable on the chosen device. The story is largely visual and interpretive, which may be appealing or may feel less concrete than dialogue-led mysteries.

An opening invitation

Move or inspect one panel in the opening arrangement and watch for a new relationship. Focus on that single change before trying to explain the whole story.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The gallery permits the pictures to disagree with their captions and the reader to enjoy a connection before finding words for it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/557600/>

P137 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Monument Valley: Panoramic Edition

The Staircase Has Exploited a Loophole in the Building Code

Edition considered: PC Panoramic Edition

I examined the staircase and declared it noncompliant. Then the view changed and the staircase connected perfectly. Tank asked whether the building code had considered perspective. I said the code was undergoing an urgent review. Shawna suggested that the review begin with turning the actual mechanism.

The little architecture made impossibility look inviting. Rosa followed the figure through a path that my first glance had dismissed. Mercedes said that sometimes a puzzle asks you to stop enforcing the rules you brought from outside it. I resisted on behalf of the building inspector, who was also me. Then I moved a piece and watched a new route appear. There was no need to conquer a continent. One elegant change had made somewhere reachable. I crossed out the violation notice and replaced it with a drawing of the staircase. Tank said the drawing also looked impossible. I decided that was progress.

The actual attraction

Monument Valley guides Ida through compact architectural illusions. Manipulating parts of the monuments changes which paths connect, giving visual discovery a clear purpose. The Panoramic PC presentation can suit someone drawn to beautiful, contained spaces rather than a freely steered open world.

The catch worth knowing

The developer describes pushing, pulling, clicking, raising and lowering parts of the scenery. Those operations need a hold-and-drag check; the game's approachable marketing is not a control guarantee. The current Steam header uses Monument Valley, while its description explicitly identifies the Panoramic edition. Keep that edition scope when checking settings and input.

An opening invitation

Complete one early architectural transformation and send Ida along the new path. Test the manipulation itself before deciding that the quiet presentation matches the desired physical comfort.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The staircase receives a temporary exemption from ordinary geometry, while the player's actual comfort remains stubbornly non-negotiable.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected correct Steam app 1927720. Current header shortens the name, but detailed description explicitly identifies Panoramic Edition and manipulation actions. Wrong or unresolved automatic cache excluded. Holds/timing not certified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1927720/>

P138 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Monument Valley 2: Panoramic Edition

The Building Has Made Room for Someone to Grow

Edition considered: PC Panoramic Edition

I designed two identical routes and called the arrangement equitable. Rosa asked whether the two travelers needed the same thing at the same moment. I said consistency was an administrative virtue. Mercedes said care sometimes required noticing a difference. Tank quietly removed the second copy of my route.

The mother and child moved through a world that changed around them. Shawna watched how the architecture expressed separation and connection without needing a speech from me. This was excellent news for everybody except my speech. I tried to understand the next shape as a relationship rather than merely a clever staircase. The puzzle still needed solving, but the reason to solve it felt warmer. I put the duplicate route in the recycling. It was not a dramatic gesture, though I attempted to give it a title. Rosa said I could let one useful act remain small.

The actual attraction

Monument Valley 2 connects architectural illusion with a story of Ro and her child. The changing paths give its themes of care and independence a visual form. The developer describes it as a standalone adventure, so interest in this relationship does not require finishing the first game.

The catch worth knowing

The PC description explicitly calls for clicking and dragging to reshape the world. That is a concrete conditional barrier, even though the presentation is calm. Check how long manipulations must be held, target size and recovery from an unintended movement. The current storefront's shorter title still identifies the Panoramic edition in its detailed description.

An opening invitation

Try one early interaction involving the two travelers and the structure around them. Assess the drag action before assuming that a gentle story means physically effortless play.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The architecture may grow with its travelers; the committee is forbidden to demand that everyone use the same staircase at the same time.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected correct Steam app 1927740. Detailed text identifies Panoramic Edition and explicitly describes clicking and dragging. Wrong or unresolved automatic cache excluded. Calm presentation is not a hold-free guarantee.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1927740/>

P139 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

The Room

The Box Contains a Smaller Reason to Distrust the Box

Edition considered: PC original game

The object looked expensive, secretive and difficult to open. Naturally, I assumed it belonged in my office. Tank asked what it did. 'It establishes atmosphere.' Shawna turned it and found something that might actually be useful. I advised caution with a tone suggesting I had noticed it first.

Every surface seemed capable of concealing a latch, a clue or another arrangement of parts. Rosa enjoyed the invitation to look closely. Mercedes asked whether I could resist declaring the first discovery a final victory. I said yes and immediately tried to announce a breakthrough. The next layer opened, proving that the breakthrough had merely acquired a hallway. We laughed and kept looking. The pleasure was not in owning the box or displaying it beside my nameplate. It was in finding the small thing that changed what the box could become. I considered that an improvement in my relationship with office equipment.

The actual attraction

The Room offers close inspection of elaborate mechanical objects within an atmospheric mystery. Cryptic letters and unusual devices give each discovered mechanism a little narrative weight. Its concentrated setting may appeal more than walking through a large world, especially when the desired activity is examining something with a purpose.

The catch worth knowing

Close-up object puzzles can demand rotation, zooming, sliding and held pointer movement. The primary PC description calls the experience tactile but does not certify click-only controls. Check a representative latch or dial and the readability of details. The eerie tone may also matter even if the player is not controlling a combat character.

An opening invitation

Inspect the first object, identify one movable part and test the exact interaction. Learn how to leave a close-up before proceeding through several layers.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The box may keep its secrets until asked properly; the minister may not replace observation with an expensive-looking nameplate.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/288160/>

P140 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

The Room Two

The Second Room Has Requested a Larger Suspicion Budget

Edition considered: PC release

I returned prepared for a box. The sequel appeared prepared to offer more than one thing worth examining. Tank watched my face as the scope expanded. 'You brought the small binder.' 'I was demonstrating restraint.' Shawna said restraint could also mean investigating one object before drafting an entire catalogue of everything suspicious.

The cryptic trail gave us a reason to keep noticing. Rosa chose a detail and followed it. Mercedes reminded me that a room was not a demand to solve every visible surface simultaneously. I found this useful because my first instinct had been to point at all of them. One mechanism suggested another. A letter gave the arrangement a different tone. The investigation developed through attention rather than volume. I left the large binder in the cupboard. Later, Tank found me considering a medium binder and gently closed the cupboard door.

The actual attraction

The Room Two continues the series' mechanical mystery while expanding the spaces and objects to investigate. Following an enigmatic scientist's letters gives the tactile puzzle work a thread to pursue. It may suit someone who liked the first game's close observation and wants a broader version of that activity.

The catch worth knowing

An expanded environment can add object and location memory to the familiar manipulation demands. Check turning, zooming, dragging and moving between viewpoints in the PC release rather than carrying over assumptions from a mobile version. The primary source establishes a rebuilt PC edition, not universal comfort or a completely untimed completion path.

An opening invitation

Investigate one object in the opening area and complete a single interaction chain. Notice whether finding the next relevant object feels inviting or starts to become visual clutter.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

The suspicion budget may increase, but it must be spent one useful detail at a time instead of on a bigger binder.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/425580/>

A Quiet Board Can Contain a Loud Problem

At the next meeting I displayed two pictures. One was a cheerful creature. The other was an ornate machine surrounded by impressive shadows. I asked the committee which was easier. Shawna asked, 'Easier to move, easier to understand, easier to read, or easier to stop thinking about?' This was an unreasonable number of useful questions for a presentation that had originally contained only two slides.

Tank said the creature could require a difficult sequence of moves. Mercedes said the machine might be lovely to inspect even if she needed a clue. Rosa said neither picture told us whether somebody had to hold a button while doing something else. I looked at my labels, which read FRIENDLY and IMPORTANT. They did not survive the discussion.

We replaced the labels with descriptions of actions. Moving one square. Turning an object. Holding and dragging a piece. Reading a clue. Remembering which room contained a symbol. Waiting for a safe moment to pass a guard. These were not interchangeable demands, and none of them could be inferred reliably from the amount of gold trim on the screen. The book's quieter page design suddenly seemed more useful than my attempted hierarchy of seriousness.

I wanted to preserve one grand distinction: a grown-up evening could include simple play without needing to apologize for it. Mercedes agreed, provided we also acknowledged the opposite. A person who wanted complicated characters should not be handed a coloring toy merely because its controls were small. Taste was part of the decision. We returned both pictures to the table with better descriptions. The creature kept its dignity. The machine lost its automatic promotion. I lost a slide deck, which everyone described as an improvement.

P141 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

The Room Three

The Invitation Has a Secret Compartment and No Return Address

Edition considered: PC release

The Craftsman sounded like someone who would understand my desk. Then I imagined arriving on a remote island with a cabinet whose drawers demanded qualifications before opening. Tank inspected the invitation. 'It doesn't say refreshments.' I said a mysterious patron would surely provide. Rosa brought a bag anyway, which is why her expedition had better survival prospects than mine.

I appointed myself Director of Small Brass Revelations. Shawna asked whether the title helped locate a hinge. It did not, although I maintained that the phrase had excellent acoustics. The attraction was the workmanship: an object seemed to hold a question in its joints. I could imagine wanting to know what the next mechanism concealed. Mercedes said that curiosity was a perfectly good reason to continue and did not need my office attached. I agreed, then tried to find somewhere on the island to hang the sign.

The actual attraction

The Room Three expands mechanical puzzle investigation into a mysterious island and the trials of an elusive Craftsman. Its rebuilt PC presentation offers richly detailed objects and spaces. This is a candidate for someone who enjoys handling intricate mysteries and wants a broader setting around the mechanisms.

The catch worth knowing

Broader spaces can increase navigation and remembered-location demands. Close manipulation still needs an exact-device check for turning, dragging and zooming; a mouse interface does not establish that everything is click-only. The inspected description does not certify every later interaction as untimed. Eerie isolation is part of the appeal, so choose it for that mood rather than assuming the title means a quiet decorating game.

An opening invitation

Inspect the first available mechanism and follow one clue to its consequence. Check manipulation comfort before treating the island's larger mysteries as a commitment.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Admit the Craftsman if the machinery invites curiosity. Reject my application to manage his drawers until I can open one.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/456750/>

P142 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

The Room 4: Old Sins

The Dollhouse Has More Affairs Than the Full-Size Office

Edition considered: PC release

The dollhouse looked like an administrative efficiency miracle. An entire estate could fit on a desk; surely I could reduce the department's rent. Tank pointed out that the tiny rooms appeared to contain a troubling amount of history. I said history was usually cheaper at that scale. Shawna asked me to stop valuing secrets by square footage.

A miniature interior made me lean into observation. A small object could imply something larger about the people missing from the real house. Rosa said that was the interesting part: the house was a story container, not simply an ornate cupboard. Mercedes declined my proposal to furnish the smallest room with a miniature gold stamp. 'Somebody already disappeared,' she said. 'Let's not add you to the paperwork.' I put the stamp away and considered what the house was actually telling us. Even a small door deserved a better question than whether my name would fit above it.

The actual attraction

Old Sins frames its mechanical puzzles around an unusual dollhouse and a disappearance at Waldegrave Manor. An engineer, his wife and a sought-after artifact give the investigation a darker domestic story. The PC edition rebuilds the visual presentation around detailed rooms and their interconnections.

The catch worth knowing

The dollhouse is a mysterious adult setting, not evidence of simple mechanics. Moving among rooms and tracking object uses can add memory demands; rotating and manipulating mechanisms may involve sustained pointer actions. Check the PC controls directly. The reviewed source establishes the premise and tactile puzzles, but leaves full-game timing and hold requirements unresolved.

An opening invitation

Explore one dollhouse area and identify what changed after a single mechanism. Continue if the relationship between the small room and the larger mystery feels satisfying.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A small house may contain a large story. It does not automatically qualify for my small-business grant or miniature executive parking.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1361320/>

P143 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

The House of Da Vinci

My Apprenticeship Has Begun with an Unflattering Comparison

Edition considered: PC release

I arrived for an imaginary Renaissance apprenticeship carrying a notebook entitled *Inventions I Would Have Thought of Eventually*. Leonardo's workshop made the cover feel ambitious. Tank suggested starting with a working paperclip. I said I was more interested in visionary infrastructure. 'You mean a shelf,' he said. 'A shelf that stays up this time.'

The workshop offered a better form of ambition: look at what the mechanism does, then figure out why it will not yet do it. Shawna inspected the parts without announcing a historic breakthrough every time she noticed a wheel. I tried that and found it surprisingly productive. Mercedes said the missing master's story might keep her interested between mechanisms. Rosa put the notebook away before I added Leonardo as a collaborator without asking. By the end of the imagined visit I had invented almost nothing, but I had paid attention. The application office considered this a promising change in professional direction.

The actual attraction

As Leonardo's apprentice, investigate his disappearance through mechanical puzzles and hidden objects in a Renaissance setting. Special devices add unusual ways to inspect the environment. The appeal is fictional intrigue joined to elaborate machinery, with an atmosphere inspired by historical inventions rather than a plain sequence of abstract boards.

The catch worth knowing

Inspecting objects can involve viewpoint changes and tactile manipulation; do not assume that a point-and-click label eliminates dragging or holds. Puzzles may require noticing small details and remembering where a device belongs. The source describes a fictional adventure, not a history lesson or a verified fully untimed control path. Test the intended PC input arrangement.

An opening invitation

Examine one early device and identify its moving parts before trying to solve everything nearby. Check whether manipulating it feels pleasant enough to support a longer mystery.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approve the apprenticeship for curiosity about mechanisms. My patent for a shelf remains under review by the person who owns the wall.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/522470/>

P144 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

The House of Da Vinci 2

The Past Has Been Asked to Correct This Morning's Filing

Edition considered: PC release

The possibility of changing the past arrived at exactly the right moment for a man who had spilled coffee on his own final report. I proposed a minor historical intervention. Shawna said an extraordinary time device probably had better work to do. Tank disagreed: that report had already consumed enough resources to qualify as a regional disaster.

We imagined following the apprentice into another tangle of mechanisms and secrets. A change in one period could matter in another; cause and effect now had architectural consequences. I immediately wanted a chart. Mercedes allowed one page and confiscated my roll of string. Rosa was interested in hearing the story unfold, which made the advertised narration useful to investigate. Nobody agreed to let me rewind a conversation merely because I had lost an argument. Apparently the technology could be miraculous while the household rules remained disappointingly stable. I ordered a fresh cup of coffee and placed it considerably farther from history.

The actual attraction

The second House of Da Vinci combines Renaissance mystery, mechanical puzzles and a device that connects past actions with present conditions. The developer describes a fully narrated story and redesigned controls. Those are useful distinctions to check when choosing this installment, particularly if hearing the narrative is part of its appeal.

The catch worth knowing

Redesigned controls are not proof of low physical demand. Test the actual manipulation, viewpoint changes and dragging on the PC version. Time travel can increase the number of relationships to remember, and narration does not guarantee that every clue is spoken. The reviewed source does not settle all later timed interactions or the option to avoid sustained input.

An opening invitation

Try one narrated scene and one mechanical interaction. Notice separately whether the voices help the story and whether the device controls feel comfortable.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Authorize travel through history for an interesting mystery. Coffee damage must still be handled with an ordinary cloth and a more sensible desk layout.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1259840/>

P145 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

The House of Da Vinci 3

The Final Report Has Revealed Two Earlier Reports

Edition considered: PC release

I liked the words trilogy finale because they implied an institution might eventually finish something. Tank asked whether I planned to begin with the final chapter and infer the paperwork backward. I said this was an advanced leadership technique. Mercedes called it arriving late and requesting a summary.

Giacomo's continuing adventure offered conspiracies, machines and a reason to follow the people involved. I pictured a cabinet opening onto a larger scheme while my own cabinet opened onto fourteen copies of the same lunch order. Shawna said the difference might be intentional design. Rosa wanted to know whether the characters would mean more after the earlier games. That seemed a better selection question than whether three was a more prestigious number than one. I withdrew my proposal for immediate admission based on seniority. The trilogy could be approached in a sensible order, unless somebody already knew its world. This concession was entered in a very small report so it would not accidentally start another trilogy.

The actual attraction

The third game concludes Giacomo's adventure with Leonardo, combining mechanical puzzles, time-related mysteries and conspiracies across Italian settings. The developer advertises voiced historical figures within the fictional story. It is most appealing as a continuation for someone already enjoying the series' machinery and atmosphere.

The catch worth knowing

A finale can carry more narrative context than a first encounter needs. Its polished presentation and claims of intuitive interaction do not verify click-only play or absence of required holds. Check the PC manipulation and camera behavior, and establish whether prior story knowledge matters to the intended experience. Full-route timing remains unverified in this source pass.

An opening invitation

Watch or inspect the opening premise without racing onward. If the characters and controls are already familiar, try one mechanism; otherwise consider starting with the first installment.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Grant continuation rights to an enjoyed mystery. A higher sequel number does not entitle my filing cabinet to describe itself as experienced.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1603640/>

P146 / PROMISING / mixed input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Carto

The Map Has Moved the Destination Closer to the Biscuits

Edition considered: PC release

I proposed solving the office's long walk to the kitchen by moving the kitchen on the map. Tank said that was not how the building worked. Then Carto presented a world where rearranging map pieces really could change the route. I asked everyone to acknowledge the visionary basis of my earlier proposal. Nobody did, although Rosa seemed interested in the practical biscuit implications.

The lovely part was the relationship between the paper world and the place you walked through. A map could be a thing to think with rather than a chore to memorize. Shawna turned our attention to the reason for the journey: a girl trying to find her way back to her grandmother and meeting people along the way. Mercedes preferred that to my plan for a cartographic convenience empire. I agreed to rearrange geography in service of reunion, with only a modest unofficial hope that one of the new paths might pass a bakery.

The actual attraction

Carto combines a journey to reunite with Granny with puzzles that rearrange the map itself. Changing the arrangement creates new paths and possibilities in the world. Friendly encounters and varied communities give the spatial puzzle a human thread, offering more story context than an isolated logic board.

The catch worth knowing

There are two activities to learn: moving the character and manipulating map pieces. Check rotation, placement, any dragging and the amount of direction holding needed for walking. The peaceful presentation is encouraging, but it does not establish every interaction as untimed or effortless. Later map relationships may demand more spatial reasoning than the first examples suggest.

An opening invitation

Complete one map change, then walk the resulting route and notice what it changed. Judge whether switching between map thinking and character movement feels natural.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approve if changing a map feels like making a useful discovery. Requests to move the actual kitchen must still include a plumbing estimate.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1172450/>

P147 / DETOUR / pointer input / pace: mixed / native co-op: no

Chants of Sennaar

The Sign May Say Welcome or Departmental Merger

Edition considered: PC release

I saw unfamiliar symbols and immediately considered issuing my own official translation. Shawna asked what evidence supported it. 'The font has authority,' I said. This was apparently not enough. Tank suggested that a man who had once misread PUSH should proceed carefully with an entire language.

Watching people and comparing uses of a symbol felt more satisfying than memorizing a dictionary somebody had handed over. A word could become plausible, then become doubtful, then suddenly connect a conversation to something else. Mercedes liked the possibility of understanding people who had been kept apart. Rosa preferred that goal to my plan for licensing all future nouns. I agreed to keep guesses provisional. The notebook became a place for evidence instead of a place where my first opinion acquired a decorative border. That was a substantial institutional reform. I tried to announce it in the new language, but Shawna suggested waiting until I knew whether my sentence requested a meeting or a bucket.

The actual attraction

Chants of Sennaar builds a tower journey around interpreting several interconnected languages. Observation, conversations and a notebook of symbols support the process of finding meaning. Its distinctive appeal is the moment when a scene becomes understandable, with communication across separated peoples supplying a larger purpose.

The catch worth knowing

The developer explicitly confirms stealth sections that require choosing a path and timing movement around guard patterns. This conflicts with a strict no-rush route. The Steam listing's mouse-only and camera-comfort declarations do not remove that demand, and the developer says the gamepad cover/free toggle does not apply to mouse-and-keyboard play. Language deduction also adds substantial memory work.

An opening invitation

Explore the early language puzzle only if that bounded visit is wanted. Preview the stealth requirements before committing; do not promise that enjoying the opening makes the full game suitable.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Admit for the pleasure of understanding a stranger. My first translation remains provisional, especially if it appears to appoint me king of the tower.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam premise and declared input categories; developer Rundisc replies of December 4, 2023 and March 23, 2024 explicitly confirm stealth timing and distinguish gamepad from mouse/keyboard. No whole-game no-rush claim.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1931770/>

Source 2: <https://steamcommunity.com/app/1931770/discussions/0/4040354734349221032/>

P148 / **CONDITIONAL** / mixed input / pace: mixed / native co-op: no

Heaven's Vault

The Ancient Inscription Has Declined to Endorse My Theory

Edition considered: PC release

An archaeologist and a robot travelling among ruins sounded like the kind of partnership I could supervise from an extremely comfortable chair. Tank asked which one would tolerate me. I said the robot might appreciate clear instructions. Shawna looked at the binder and said that would make two of us looking for them.

The writing on a discovered object invited a theory about the people who made it. Another discovery might strengthen the theory or knock a leg out from under it. Mercedes liked a story in which understanding could change without everyone pretending the earlier guess had never happened. Rosa wanted the relationship between the traveller and her companion to matter as much as the stones. I prepared to enjoy both, then caught myself writing **CERTIFIED TRANSLATION** at the top of an uncertain page. Shawna replaced it with **WORKING IDEA**. The new label was less magnificent, but it had the advantage of being true.

The actual attraction

Heaven's Vault follows archaeologist Aliya and her robot companion Six through a network of places and histories. Translating an ancient language is woven into an adaptive story, where discoveries and interpretations affect the journey. It offers grown-up curiosity, character exchanges and the possibility of forming a theory that later evidence complicates.

The catch worth knowing

This is more than a static translation screen: exploration includes navigation and sailing, and the source describes fast-flowing space rivers. Check camera movement, sustained travel input and the handling of those sequences. Tracking inscriptions, earlier interpretations and story choices can be demanding. Do not read its reflective subject matter as proof that every physical action waits comfortably.

An opening invitation

Try one conversation and one inscription before evaluating a travel sequence separately. Keep a translation provisional and notice whether uncertainty feels intriguing or merely burdensome.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approve archaeology for anyone who enjoys a theory with room to grow. My stamp cannot turn an attractive guess into a discovered fact.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/774201/>

P149 / CONDITIONAL / camera input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Return of the Obra Dinn

The Insurance Form Has Become an Entire Ship

Edition considered: PC release

I volunteered to assess an abandoned merchant ship because, for once, somebody had admitted that paperwork was central to the adventure. Tank asked whether I had maritime experience. I said I had successfully carried soup across a room. Shawna explained that this did not constitute a qualification in identifying what happened to a missing crew.

The assignment suggested a more serious version of observation: people, places and small details might connect into an account of events. Mercedes wanted the mystery, but refused my proposal to issue conclusions before examining the evidence. Rosa said the crew should feel like people whose stories mattered, not spaces I was eager to fill in. That changed the mood around the imaginary desk. I put away the celebratory stamp. A strange ship could be fascinating without turning loss into a scoreboard. Tank kept the soup on land, where my demonstrated competence remained narrow but reasonably well documented.

The actual attraction

Return of the Obra Dinn casts the player as an insurance investigator examining a merchant ship that has returned without its crew. The developer emphasizes first-person exploration and logical deduction. Its appeal is reconstructing a complicated human mystery through observation, making it a strong story-and-evidence candidate for the right input setup.

The catch worth knowing

First-person navigation brings camera coordination and movement holds into the assessment. Connecting many identities and events can also impose a large memory burden, while the ship's fate involves death and disturbing material. The inspected primary description is brief; it does not establish every timing or interaction requirement. Choose it for substantial deduction, not as a low-effort introduction to mysteries.

An opening invitation

Inspect the opening environment and the investigation interface. Check visual comfort and navigation before deciding whether maintaining a larger network of people and clues sounds enjoyable.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Admit the investigator only after checking the ship's controls. My soup certificate will not be accepted as evidence of maritime expertise.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/653530/>

P150 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Opus Magnum

The Machine Works but the Management Has Opinions

Edition considered: PC release

I wanted a machine that would place the gold stamp on a page, admire the result, and then quietly perform all the work the stamp implied. Opus Magnum appeared more interested in making transformations actually happen. Tank said this was already an improvement on the department's current business model.

Programmable arms, tracks and repeating operations gave my imaginary workshop a clear question: could this arrangement produce the required result? Shawna built a small logical explanation while I considered a ceremonial name for the machine. Mercedes said a working solution could be enough, even if somebody else's was smaller or faster. That statement threatened the entire Bureau of Comparative Excellence, so I took a moment to process it. Rosa suggested watching the parts move once they were doing the right thing. There was pleasure in that, separate from winning an argument about efficiency. I approved the first working arrangement and resisted adding an arm whose sole job was to point at my name.

The actual attraction

Opus Magnum is an open-ended machine-building puzzle about arranging and programming alchemical equipment. Several solutions can work, with optional interest in making them cheaper, smaller or faster. A story of ambition and intrigue surrounds the workshop, while watching a successful mechanism repeat its work provides a distinctive reward.

The catch worth knowing

The editor, component placement and instruction sequencing create substantial interface and reasoning demands. Optimization comparisons can introduce self-imposed pressure even when a solution already works. Machine execution speed is not the same thing as required human reaction speed, but exact editing holds and all control requirements still need checking. The narrative is woven around construction rather than replacing it.

An opening invitation

Follow one introductory construction and make a single operation work. Ignore efficiency comparisons while deciding whether arranging and revising a machine is enjoyable in itself.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approve a machine because it works and is satisfying to watch. An extra arm dedicated to congratulating its inventor is not a necessary component.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/558990/>

The Museum of Working Things

We opened the retro cabinet with appropriate ceremony. Tank held the door so it would not strike the table. I announced that every artifact within had survived an era of inferior management and therefore deserved respect. Shawna asked which one currently worked on the available equipment. The ceremony paused while the museum encountered the difference between historical interest and an actual evening's entertainment.

A mouse from an old console suggested a small creative studio. A city simulator suggested systems, budgets and a skyline. A contraption builder suggested a ball reaching an objective by the most entertaining possible route. These were distinct invitations. Mercedes refused to let the single word retro make them interchangeable. Rosa also refused to let nostalgia turn setup trouble into a social obligation. A lovely memory could stay lovely without everyone spending the evening chasing an unavailable driver.

We wrote down what was known from a manual or an exact-edition source and what still needed checking. A source gap stayed a source gap. A scan we could locate but not read did not become a control audit because I looked solemn beside it. I offered to issue a provisional seal. Shawna said the plain sentence about the gap was already doing more useful work than the seal would.

Tank found the red stapler in the cabinet and asked whether I intended to classify it as a historical pointing device. I said its original firmware was still intact. He stapled two loose sheets, demonstrating compatibility with paper. That was the strongest hands-on evidence produced during the ceremony. We left the cabinet open, placed the useful notes beside it, and agreed that an old favorite should earn its place through present enjoyment, with history allowed to make the invitation warmer.

P151 / PROMISING / directional input / pace: waits / native co-op: no

Sokobond

The Molecule Has Rejected an Unnecessary Management Layer

Edition considered: PC release

I looked at a small arrangement of atoms and proposed adding a supervisor. Shawna explained that this was a chemistry puzzle, not a staffing dispute. 'Everything benefits from coordination,' I said. Tank pointed out that the atoms appeared to be doing substantially better without a meeting.

The appeal was a compact problem that could change meaning as the pieces connected. I did not need to turn the room into a laboratory or pretend I remembered every chemical symbol from school. Mercedes appreciated the promise that prior chemistry knowledge was unnecessary; she wanted to discover the rules through the puzzle itself. Rosa asked whether the quiet presentation hid a serious challenge. It could, which seemed like a fair arrangement if the challenge was enjoyable. I removed the supervisor from my diagram. A small system had enough relationships already. Then I tried to charge the department for the successful removal of an unnecessary position and discovered that everyone remembered who had proposed it.

The actual attraction

Sokobond turns molecular connections into compact logic puzzles with a minimalist presentation. The developer explicitly says chemistry knowledge is not required. Its current Steam declarations include keyboard-only play and play without timed input, making this a useful candidate when deliberate problem-solving is welcome but reaction pressure is not.

The catch worth knowing

A small control vocabulary can still support difficult spatial reasoning. Confirm comfortable key presses, any repeat behavior and how undo works on the actual device. The developer's no-timed-input declaration is useful evidence, not a hands-on comfort guarantee. This is mainly abstract puzzle pleasure; it will not supply the character-rich narrative that motivates some other choices in the catalog.

An opening invitation

Try one introductory molecular puzzle and learn the result of a single movement. Continue only if revising a spatial idea feels satisfying, without requiring prior chemistry expertise.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approve bonds that make a good puzzle. Deny my proposal to place an executive atom above the others and call the arrangement leadership.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam source supports chemistry-themed puzzles without required chemistry knowledge. Current developer declarations include Keyboard Only Option and Playable without Timed Input. Those declarations are not a hands-on test of sustained keys or individual comfort. Remote Play Together is not treated as native co-op.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/290260/>

P152 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Hexcells

The Hexagon Has Filed Six Equally Valid Complaints

Edition considered: PC original game

I chose a hexagonal form because it looked more advanced than the department's rectangles. Tank asked whether six sides made the instructions any clearer. I said the additional edges offered room for innovation. Shawna said they mostly offered room for me to write six versions of the same vague sentence.

A quiet field of cells was a more appealing use of the shape. There could be pleasure in finding one justified move, then letting it reveal another. Mercedes said that sounded like a good reason to sit down if the clues were readable. Rosa suggested removing the theatrical briefing so the actual instructions could be seen. I obliged, reluctantly folding my hexagonal agenda into a shape best described as damaged. The puzzle did not need an invented story about national importance. A visible pattern and a small piece of certainty might be enough. My form was reassigned as a coaster, where its unusually generous perimeter finally served a practical purpose.

The actual attraction

Hexcells is presented by its developer as an ambient logic puzzle. Its compact cell-based format offers a different kind of interest from walking through a world: inspect the board, understand its rules and look for a reasoned next step. It is a candidate for someone who likes deliberate abstract deduction.

The catch worth knowing

The inspected primary description is unusually brief, so it does not substantiate a full no-timer or hold-free claim. Check the game's instructions, cell readability and the distinction between its input actions before relying on it. A sparse screen does not guarantee an easy deduction. This original Hexcells entry should not inherit features or extra modes from the separate Plus and Infinite games.

An opening invitation

Read the opening board instructions and make one move whose reason is clear. Check whether selecting and distinguishing cells feels comfortable before increasing the puzzle size.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Grant six-sided logic a hearing if its clues invite another look. The department's hexagonal stationery remains a beverage accessory until its wording improves.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

The exact-game Steam page describes an ambient logic puzzle; its short primary text does not establish full controls or timing. The separate sequels' features were not imported. Detailed input verification remains outstanding.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/265890/>

P153 / **CONDITIONAL** / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Tametsi

The Tiles Have Demanded Evidence Before Anyone Touches Them

Edition considered: PC release

I arrived with a strategy called Probably That One. Tametsi's promise of logic-based solutions made the strategy seem professionally weak. Shawna asked me to explain a move. I pointed confidently. She waited. Tank said confidence was not a number, although I had been submitting it as one for years.

The board invited a stricter pleasure: a conclusion that followed from what was visible. Mercedes liked that the game did not need guesses, but she wanted the word difficult printed somewhere I could not cover with my stamp. Rosa liked the possibility of leaving an unfinished puzzle without losing the work, since an interruption should not become an administrative incident. I considered the drawing tools as a place to keep a real argument instead of a speech about my intuition. There was something satisfying about admitting that a tile should remain untouched until the evidence supported it. The department briefly experienced the unfamiliar sensation of having fewer conclusions than claims.

The actual attraction

Tametsi offers demanding logic puzzles about finding hidden mines among tiles. The developer says solutions do not require guessing, provides on-screen drawing tools for notes, and saves progress even within a level. For someone who enjoys careful deduction, those features can support a substantial problem without requiring an immediate answer.

The catch worth knowing

The developer also explicitly describes the game as difficult. Large patterns, written notes and relationships between clues can become mentally busy even when the physical action is modest. Verify the click controls, tile visibility and stopping behavior on the device. The inspected text supports automatic progress saving, but it does not explicitly certify every input as hold-free or every activity as untimed.

An opening invitation

Try an early board and write down one deduction with the available note tools. Decide whether the reasoning itself is enjoyable before treating more difficult boards as an objective.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Admit a conclusion when the clues support it. My pointing finger has been demoted from Evidence Department to General Direction Services.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/709920/>

P154 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: mixed / native co-op: no

Mario Paint

The Stamp Department Has Finally Found Its Medium

Edition considered: 1992 SNES original; SNES Mouse input

I had spent several volumes defending stamps as a serious creative instrument. Mario Paint offered a room where that defense might actually stand up. Tank looked at a row of repeated pictures and said I had found a form of bureaucracy with better colors. I chose to accept this as professional recognition.

Rosa wanted to make a small picture without turning the process into an art examination. Mercedes wanted to see what happened when a ridiculous little image was repeated in a pleasing arrangement. Shawna directed us toward stamps and fills before I disappeared into every icon on the screen. The mouse made the old console feel like a tiny studio. I proposed composing the department's official anthem as well, but Tank said we should first establish whether the picture needed fourteen copies of my favorite symbol. It did not. We removed thirteen and suddenly it looked intentional. This remains one of the few documented occasions when reducing my contribution improved the composition.

The actual attraction

The original SNES Mario Paint is a creative toy for pictures, music and animation, built around the SNES Mouse. Stamping and filling areas offer a narrower first activity than exploring the entire toolbox. Its appeal is making something playful, with nostalgia as an optional bonus rather than a requirement.

The catch worth knowing

The original hardware needs the mouse peripheral. Manual instructions distinguish simple selections from held-button dragging used by other tools, so the whole program is not hold-free. Many icons and palette choices can create menu clutter. The separate Gnat Attack activity adds reaction demands and is outside this suggested stamp-and-fill trial. This is creation, not a character-story adventure.

An opening invitation

Choose one stamp and one fill color, then make a small picture. Leave freehand dragging, animation and the reaction minigame aside while checking mouse comfort.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Authorize the gold stamp to pursue an artistic career, provided it accepts criticism and does not fill every available inch with evidence of its own existence.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo announcement confirms the 1992 original; original Nintendo manual transcription, hosted by a third party, distinguishes stamps/fills from held dragging and the separate Gnat Attack activity. Card scope is original SNES Mouse play, not an automatic claim about modern ports.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/whatsnew/mario-paint-scribbles-into-the-super-nes-collection/>

Source 2: <https://manualzz.com/doc/26101036/nintendo-mario-paint-family-user-manual>

P155 / DETOUR / directional input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Color a Dinosaur

The Dinosaur Has Requested One Color and No Brand Strategy

Edition considered: 1993 NES original

I prepared a presentation about restoring the dinosaur's public image. Mercedes asked whether the animal had requested this service. I said it had left several areas uncolored, which I considered an invitation to develop a visual identity. Tank said it looked more like an invitation to choose a color.

The attraction here was deliberately narrow: an old console, a picture and a small set of choices. Rosa could see a place for that if someone actually wanted the nostalgia. Shawna could also see the danger of offering it to a person who had asked for a richer story and calling the mismatch kindness. I put the presentation away. The dinosaur did not become a more grown-up mystery because I gave it a committee. It remained a simple coloring toy, available to enjoy on exactly those terms. Mercedes chose a ridiculous color and laughed. That was a good enough reason for the choice; it did not require me to pretend the picture concealed an epic.

The actual attraction

Color a Dinosaur is an original NES coloring toy with a deliberately small activity loop. Its manual describes selecting pictures and filling regions with colors, including a point-to-point control arrangement. It belongs here as a specific retro curiosity for someone who wants that simple action, not as a substitute for adult narrative.

The catch worth knowing

The presentation is aimed at young children and the variety is limited. That may be a taste veto regardless of how few controls are needed. The original manual supports the coloring controls, while full-play timing and modern-device behavior have not been tested here. Mode changes can affect the drawing; check the intended setup rather than assuming an emulator reproduces every behavior conveniently.

An opening invitation

If the retro coloring idea itself appeals, fill a few regions in one picture. Stop the trial once its narrow appeal is clear; completing a picture is optional.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Admit the dinosaur only by personal invitation. No amount of executive branding can turn a coloring toy into the grown-up mystery somebody asked for.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Original manual scan, hosted by a third party, was visually examined in the earlier project research (work/retro-games.json); current reopen yielded no searchable text. Manual-supported point-to-point coloring is a narrow option, not a tested whole-game or emulator guarantee. Wrong Steam coloring-game match excluded.

Source 1: <https://www.digitpress.com/library/manuals/nes/Color%20a%20Dinosaur.pdf>

P156 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: unknown

The Incredible Machine 3

The Ball Will Ring the Bell After Several Avoidable Expenses

Edition considered: 1995 Windows original

I could see the appeal immediately: a simple task achieved through an arrangement so elaborate that everyone else would wonder why I had not just done the task. Tank said the department had finally found its autobiography. I objected because our office did not contain a balloon-powered component. 'Give you another hour,' he said.

The imagined contraption had a ball, a useful object, and more connecting logic than the result strictly required. Shawna wanted to know whether changing one part would explain the failure. Mercedes liked the comedy of an absurd mechanism that genuinely worked. Rosa asked whether we could celebrate a small successful chain without rebuilding the entire table. I agreed, although the agreement was difficult because a pulley seemed like the kind of thing the table had been missing. We kept the experiment modest. A practical outcome reached by a wonderfully impractical route felt like honest entertainment, provided nobody confused it with my preferred method for organizing everybody else's evening.

The actual attraction

The Incredible Machine 3 is a historical contraption-building puzzle candidate: arrange parts into chains of cause and effect to achieve an objective. Its appeal is seeing an unlikely mechanism succeed after a useful adjustment. This 1995 Windows entry is included for a revisit if an existing copy and workable setup are available.

The catch worth knowing

Evidence is weaker here than for the modern store entries. A Sierra historical archive identifies the game, but its descriptive text credits a secondary database; the linked scanned manual was located without usable text verification. Exact mouse actions, timers, compatibility and present availability remain unresolved. Do not mistake this historical candidate for a certified easy-to-run or hold-free recommendation.

An opening invitation

On a working existing setup, inspect one introductory contraption and its controls before changing a single component. Avoid turning software setup into the evening's main activity.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approve a ridiculous machine when its workings are the pleasure. Deny my attempt to use that principle as the department's purchasing policy.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Explicit source gap: historical Sierra archive page inspected, but its descriptive prose credits MobyGames. Original scanned manual located, not successfully read for mechanics in this pass. Primary identity locator is available; detailed controls, timing, current availability and compatibility remain unverified.

Source 1: <https://www.sierragamers.com/tim-3/>

Source 2: https://www.sierragamers.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/12/TIM_3_Manual.pdf

P157 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: mixed / native co-op: no

SimCity 2000 Special Edition

The Mayor Has Built a Monument Before Asking About Water

Edition considered: PC Special Edition

I laid out a magnificent avenue leading directly to the mayor's office. Tank asked where the residents lived. I said that was the next phase of civic excellence. Shawna asked about utilities. I pointed to the avenue again, which did not improve its ability to supply water.

A city-building game could make these decisions interesting because the city would have reasons to care about them. Mercedes liked the thought of shaping a place, then seeing how its parts related. Rosa preferred a neighborhood people might enjoy to a skyline designed entirely for my portrait. I began to understand why a city was more than a large arrangement of attractive blocks. It also meant that this was not the same kind of evening as placing a few decorative houses. The council could not honestly promise simplicity while handing over a budget. I reduced the proposed monument to a bench, and even that remained conditional on somebody actually having a place to live.

The actual attraction

SimCity 2000 Special Edition offers the classic city-building and management fantasy, with the ability to design a settlement and respond to its needs. The current exact-edition store description includes additional cities and scenarios. It may appeal through nostalgia, long-term planning and the satisfaction of a place taking shape.

The catch worth knowing

Management brings budgets, services, tools and simulation behavior into the same interface. This is a meaningful increase in menu and system complexity, not a default low-demand choice. Check speed controls, pausing, the ability to inspect while paused and the readability of the old interface on the intended setup. The reviewed sources do not establish a special no-pressure mode or hold-free operation.

An opening invitation

Inspect an existing city or an introductory situation and identify one service before building extensively. Decide whether managing relationships between systems sounds enjoyable, rather than merely liking the skyline.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Authorize the mayor only if planning is the attraction. The monument budget stays frozen until the ordinary neighborhood has something useful beneath its impressive view.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Special Edition GOG listing and official EA title page inspected. Supports city design/management and edition identity; pause behavior, no-pressure modes and present-device control comfort were not verified.

Source 1: https://www.gog.com/en/game/simcity_2000_special_edition

Source 2: <https://www.ea.com/games/simcity/simcity-2000>

P158 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: mixed / native co-op: no

RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe

The Queue Has Become Longer Than the Official Speech

Edition considered: PC Deluxe edition

I designed a grand entrance and prepared to welcome the first guests with a speech. Tank examined the imaginary queue and suggested that people had come for rides. I said the speech would establish the park's values. Mercedes asked whether one of those values was eventually letting people reach a roller coaster.

The park offered both a visual pleasure and an operational problem. Paths, rides and guests could become a place worth looking at, but the visitors also brought needs and expectations. Shawna wanted to start with something already built before allowing me to design an attraction with six official opening ceremonies. Rosa proposed one comfortable corner with a sensible route through it. I began to see why a prebuilt ride could be a useful beginning rather than an insult to creativity. The first successful improvement might be small. I cut the speech to one sentence, which made the queue shorter in spirit even before anybody touched the paths.

The actual attraction

RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe combines the original park-management game with its two expansion packs. It offers both custom coaster construction and prebuilt rides, alongside the business of keeping guests and finances in order. The pleasure can be a recognizable little park evolving through practical and creative decisions.

The catch worth knowing

Designing rides is only part of the game: management menus, guest needs, money and scenario demands can create pressure. Check simulation speed and pause behavior, exact mouse operations and interface size. The presence of prebuilt rides does not remove the rest of the management system, and this edition should not be credited with modes from later RollerCoaster Tycoon releases.

An opening invitation

Inspect an opening park or scenario and locate one prebuilt attraction in the interface. Evaluate whether the management surrounding construction feels interesting before committing to a large custom coaster.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approve a park for someone who enjoys designing a place and managing its consequences. My welcoming speech must remain shorter than the path to the first ride.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/285310/>

P159 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: mixed / native co-op: no

Theme Hospital

The Administrator Has Bought a Fountain Instead of a Sensible Floor Plan

Edition considered: 1997 PC original

I proposed improving institutional confidence with a spectacular entrance. Shawna asked whether the building's actual rooms were ready. I said the fountain would communicate readiness. Tank said it would communicate water, and only if we had remembered the pipe.

Theme Hospital's absurd institution seemed likely to understand the gap between official ambition and everyday operations. Mercedes was interested in the satire but declined any attempt to turn the evening into a real discussion of medical experiences. Rosa agreed: the joke could stay on ridiculous management, especially mine. We imagined the consequences of making a decorative decision while the useful work waited. It was an uncomfortable mirror, although a funny one. I moved the fountain down the plan. Shawna moved it off the plan. Tank suggested replacing it with a sign reading THE ADMINISTRATOR HAS BEEN ASKED TO CONSIDER OTHER PEOPLE. I objected to the length, then recognized that reducing the message would probably make it about me again.

The actual attraction

Bullfrog's original Theme Hospital is a comic management game about designing and running an institution with limited resources. The official EA page emphasizes building, maintaining and managing the hospital while balancing cash and its exaggerated fictional problems. Its appeal is institutional satire and operational tinkering, rather than a rich personal adventure.

The catch worth knowing

Staff, rooms, resources and developing demands can make this a busy management choice. Its comic visual style does not remove time pressure or menu work. Check pausing, speed behavior, readable text and the exact mouse controls before assuming a relaxed setup is possible. The humor includes exaggerated illnesses and death, which may simply be the wrong subject for an enjoyable evening.

An opening invitation

Inspect the early building and management interface without committing to an elaborate plan. Decide whether its subject and overlapping responsibilities are appealing before taking on the continuing simulation.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Admit the satire only when its subject is welcome. Reject the fountain until the administrator can explain what useful problem it is supposed to solve.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Official EA page identifies Bullfrog's original 1997 Theme Hospital and building/management with limited resources. The automatic Steam hit was unrelated DLC and is excluded. Exact pause/hold behavior remains to be checked.

Source 1: <https://www.ea.com/games/theme/theme-hospital>

P160 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Zoombinis

The Travellers Have Asked Me to Stop Improving Their Names

Edition considered: 2015 PC remake of Logical Journey of the Zoombinis

A group of small blue travellers needed a way forward. I offered a full naming convention, complete with reference numbers and an organizational chart. Rosa said they already had enough to deal with. Tank suggested that helping them through the actual puzzle would be a more convincing welcome.

The old logic-journey idea had an honest attraction: notice a pattern, make a choice, see whether the group could continue. Mercedes wanted the childhood-adventure presentation described plainly so nostalgia could do its own work. Shawna pointed out that an inviting cartoon could still contain a serious rule to figure out. I agreed to stop confusing appearance with difficulty in either direction. Some evenings might welcome these peculiar travellers; others might want a human mystery with complicated motives. Neither preference required a hearing. I retired the naming chart and concentrated on the route. The travellers retained their own identities, and the department was spared an unnecessary argument over whether a person could be filed under Blue.

The actual attraction

This is the 2015 remake of Logical Journey of the Zoombinis, a cartoon adventure built around pattern and logic puzzles. The developer describes twelve puzzle types with several difficulty levels as the travellers seek a new home. It may appeal through nostalgic character, rule discovery and a sequence of distinct reasoning tasks.

The catch worth knowing

The child-oriented presentation is a real taste consideration, especially when the desired experience is a grown-up character story. Logic difficulty can increase independently of that appearance. Check the specific puzzle's clicking, dragging, penalties and timing; the store description does not establish a universally untimed or hold-free route. This entry refers to the remake, not every older edition or platform version.

An opening invitation

Try one early puzzle and explain the pattern you think matters. Check whether helping these characters feels charming before investing in harder levels or the larger journey.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approve the travellers if their particular charm is wanted. The department has no authority to replace personal taste with nostalgia or a compulsory naming system.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/397430/>

The Last Compartment

By the end of the department's review, the cabinet contained fewer things than I had intended and more things we could actually find. The gold stamp had a small space of its own. The red stapler sat where a hand could reach it. The binder had become several manageable volumes. Tank opened the door and closed it again without holding the entire structure steady, which I described as a major infrastructure milestone. He described it as a cabinet.

We did not finish every puzzle in order to justify their existence. Some pages made somebody curious immediately. Others revealed a catch that settled the choice just as usefully. A drag could be unwelcome. A dense logic board could be exactly the right invitation. A beautifully told mystery could still include timing that ruled it out for a particular evening. The point of the collection was to make those differences visible before my enthusiasm tried to run over them with a ceremonial trolley.

Mercedes chose a page because she liked the premise, then checked the burden before considering the first action. Rosa set the tea where nobody had to reach across the book. Shawna left a blank line beside an unresolved control question. Tank put the spare fittings in a small bag and wrote CABINET on it. I admired the economy of that label while privately considering whether Cabinet Affairs would sound more established.

There was one compartment left. I proposed reserving it for future expansion. Mercedes suggested leaving it empty until something worth keeping appeared. This felt dangerously unambitious until I noticed how calm the shelf looked without a speculative monument to my plans. An empty place was not a failure to choose. It was room for the next thing that actually appealed.

I put away the final form. Nobody had signed it, and nothing important had gone wrong. The guest could pick a puzzle, return to a story, try a creative toy, or close the book. The cabinet did not award points for finishing its contents. Neither, after a brief and unsuccessful attempt to add a scoring drawer, did I. Tank shut the door. For once the department's most convincing achievement was that everything useful remained easy to reach.

An index with no authority over you

The case number works in every format. The last column is this volume's printed page. Click a title in the PDF to jump to it.

P126	A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build	10	P149	Return of the Obra Dinn	35
P128	A Monster's Expedition	12	P158	RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe	45
P121	Baba Is You	5	P157	SimCity 2000 Special Edition	44
P129	Bonfire Peaks	13	P124	Snakebird	8
P131	Braid, Anniversary Edition	16	P125	Snakebird Primer	9
P130	Can of Wormholes	14	P151	Sokobond	38
P146	Carto	32	P123	Stephen's Sausage Roll	7
P147	Chants of Sennaar	33	P153	Tametsi	40
P135	COCOON	20	P143	The House of Da Vinci	29
P155	Color a Dinosaur	42	P144	The House of Da Vinci 2	30
P127	Cosmic Express	11	P145	The House of Da Vinci 3	31
P136	Gorogoa	21	P156	The Incredible Machine 3	43
P148	Heaven's Vault	34	P139	The Room	24
P152	Hexcells	39	P142	The Room 4: Old Sins	28
P134	HUMANITY	19	P141	The Room Three	27
P154	Mario Paint	41	P140	The Room Two	25
P138	Monument Valley 2: Panoramic Edition	23	P159	Theme Hospital	46
P137	Monument Valley: Panoramic Edition	22	P132	World of Goo	17
P150	Opus Magnum	36	P133	World of Goo 2	18
P122	Patrick's Parabox	6	P160	Zoombinis	47

Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. Original Panorama prose, system design, research compilation and production: ChatGPT. A new companion experiment using the user-directed Ten Toes Down characters; the existing novels remain intact. Dedicated to Lillian and to the pleasure of finding something worth another turn.

Voice sources sampled: the revised Ten Toes Down six-book edition, especially Book I's funeral opening and Book II's academy arrival, plus the repository editorial record. Repository snapshot: 4f38948aa5fa97f294adfa74a0b7055c399b2826. The complete novels were not reread line by line for this project.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and <https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.